

Perfect 🚀 Let's continue with **Module 21: Triggers**.



SQL CLASS NOTE – MODULE 21: TRIGGERS

1. Introduction

A **Trigger** in SQL is a **special stored program** that automatically executes in response to certain events on a table.

👉 Events can be:

- INSERT
- UPDATE
- DELETE

👉 Triggers are useful for:

- Enforcing **business rules**
- Maintaining **audit logs**
- Ensuring **data integrity**

2. Syntax

```
CREATE TRIGGER trigger_name
{BEFORE | AFTER} {INSERT | UPDATE | DELETE}
ON table_name
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    -- SQL statements
END;
```

- **BEFORE**: Trigger runs **before** the operation.
- **AFTER**: Trigger runs **after** the operation.
- **OLD**: Refers to the row before the change (UPDATE/DELETE).

- **NEW:** Refers to the row after the change (INSERT/UPDATE).

3. Practical Examples with SchoolDB

Example 1: Audit log when a student is inserted

```
CREATE TABLE StudentAudit (  
    AuditID INT AUTO_INCREMENT PRIMARY KEY,  
    ActionType VARCHAR(20),  
    StudentID INT,  
    ActionDate TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP  
);  
  
CREATE TRIGGER after_student_insert  
AFTER INSERT ON Students  
FOR EACH ROW  
BEGIN  
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)  
    VALUES ('INSERT', NEW.StudentID);  
END;
```

Example 2: Prevent deleting students who are still enrolled

```
CREATE TRIGGER prevent_student_delete  
BEFORE DELETE ON Students  
FOR EACH ROW  
BEGIN  
    IF EXISTS (SELECT 1 FROM Enrollments WHERE StudentID = OLD.StudentID) THEN  
        SIGNAL SQLSTATE '45000'  
        SET MESSAGE_TEXT = 'Cannot delete student who is enrolled in a course';  
    END IF;  
END;
```

Example 3: Automatically set default grade when inserting a student

```
CREATE TRIGGER set_default_grade
BEFORE INSERT ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    IF NEW.GradeLevel IS NULL THEN
        SET NEW.GradeLevel = 'Grade 9';
    END IF;
END;
```

Example 4: Update audit log when a student's age is updated

```
CREATE TRIGGER after_student_update
AFTER UPDATE ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)
    VALUES ('UPDATE', NEW.StudentID);
END;
```

Example 5: Log deleted students

```
CREATE TRIGGER after_student_delete
AFTER DELETE ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)
    VALUES ('DELETE', OLD.StudentID);
END;
```

4. Why Use Triggers?

-  Enforce **automatic rules**.
-  Maintain **data accuracy**.

-  Keep **audit trails**.
-  Prevent invalid operations.

5. Real-Life Use Cases

- **Schools:** Auto-log student insertions, updates, or deletions.
- **Banks:** Track every deposit/withdrawal in a log.
- **E-commerce:** Update inventory automatically after purchase.
- **Hospitals:** Record patient discharge automatically when deleted.

6. Classwork (Practice)

1. Create a trigger that logs student inserts into `StudentAudit`.
2. Create a trigger that prevents deleting a student if they are enrolled.
3. Create a trigger that sets `GradeLevel = 'Grade 9'` if no grade is given.
4. Create a trigger that logs updates on the `Students` table.
5. Create a trigger that logs deletions on the `Students` table.

7. Challenge Question

 Create a trigger called `update_course_count` that automatically updates the total number of students enrolled in a course whenever a new enrollment is added.

 That's the **expanded Module 21: Triggers**.

 Perfect  Let's solve the **Module 21 Classwork + Challenge** step by step with SQL trigger definitions.



Solutions to Module 21: TRIGGERS

1. Create a trigger that logs student inserts into StudentAudit .

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_after_student_insert
AFTER INSERT ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)
    VALUES ('INSERT', NEW.StudentID);
END;
```

2. Create a trigger that prevents deleting a student if they are enrolled.

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_prevent_student_delete
BEFORE DELETE ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    IF EXISTS (SELECT 1 FROM Enrollments WHERE StudentID = OLD.StudentID) THEN
        SIGNAL SQLSTATE '45000'
        SET MESSAGE_TEXT = 'Cannot delete student who is enrolled in a course';
    END IF;
END;
```

3. Create a trigger that sets GradeLevel = 'Grade 9' if no grade is given.

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_set_default_grade
BEFORE INSERT ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    IF NEW.GradeLevel IS NULL THEN
        SET NEW.GradeLevel = 'Grade 9';
    END IF;
END;
```

4. Create a trigger that logs updates on the `students` table.

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_after_student_update
AFTER UPDATE ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)
    VALUES ('UPDATE', NEW.StudentID);
END;
```

5. Create a trigger that logs deletions on the `students` table.

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_after_student_delete
AFTER DELETE ON Students
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    INSERT INTO StudentAudit (ActionType, StudentID)
    VALUES ('DELETE', OLD.StudentID);
END;
```



Challenge Question

👉 Create a trigger called `update_course_count` that updates the total number of students in a course whenever a new enrollment is added.

Step 1: Add a column `TotalEnrollments` to `Courses` (if not already there).

```
ALTER TABLE Courses ADD COLUMN TotalEnrollments INT DEFAULT 0;
```

Step 2: Create the trigger.

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_update_course_count
AFTER INSERT ON Enrollments
FOR EACH ROW
BEGIN
    UPDATE Courses
    SET TotalEnrollments = TotalEnrollments + 1
    WHERE CourseID = NEW.CourseID;
END;
```

✦ Now, whenever a new enrollment is added, the related course's student count is automatically updated.

✅ That completes **Module 21: Triggers**.